

you can tweak gain, apply noise reduction, and adjust EQ settings. On paper, it sounds comprehensive. In reality, it feels basic. The controls are there, but the overall experience is not particularly polished. More importantly, all gain adjustments have to be done through the software because there is no physical knob on the mic. And that, in my opinion, can be a bit of a hassle.

Also, even if you do understand how audio settings work, having to open software every time you want to tweak gain is not very convenient. And if you don't usually spend hours fine-tuning audio profiles, the whole idea can feel slightly intimidating.

Moreover, there is no headphone jack for real-time monitoring. That means you cannot plug in your headphones directly to hear how you sound. For beginners experimenting with voiceovers or singing clips, this could have been helpful. It is a small omission, but one that limits flexibility.

The good part is that the mic does include a large tap to mute button on the top, which is more handy than you might realise. During gaming or while taking calls, I could instantly mute myself without fumbling for short-cuts whenever my mom yelled at me that dinner was ready and I should turn my PC off (sigh).

Performance

Now, the most important aspect of any device is, of course, performance. And given its price, the SoloCast 2 scores well in this area. I tested it during sessions of Phasmophobia and Battlefield

6, and my friends said I sounded clearer and better than usual. They could hear me easily during those intense sessions and never complained about the voice quality.

That said, it is still a sensitive condenser mic with a cardioid pattern. It does pick up background noise. My keyboard clicks were audible, and any desk movement came through unless I was careful. Mounting it closer to my mouth improved the voice-to-noise ratio significantly, but with just the built-in stand, you need to be mindful of placement.

For occasional voiceovers, it delivered clean recordings with decent depth. I also have a silly hobby of singing karaoke songs and recording them just for fun. The SoloCast 2 handled that well too. It is not a studio microphone, but for casual covers and playful experiments, it was more than adequate. The 24-bit / 96 kHz support gives it enough headroom to sound detailed without feeling compressed.

Should you buy the HyperX SoloCast 2?

The HyperX SoloCast 2 is for gamers like me who spend most of their time in story-driven titles but occasionally play multiplayer games too and want clearer audio on Discord without setting up a complicated rig. It also suits anyone who records voiceovers once in a while and prefers not to tangle with bulky equipment or confusing audio controls.

Meanwhile, if you are building a professional setup, you will probably want something with more control, hardware gain adjustment, and direct monitoring. Keep in mind,

this is not a studio-grade microphone and it also doesn't pretend to be.

At an asking price of Rs 4,499, the HyperX SoloCast 2 strikes a sweet balance between price and performance. It is easy to use, sounds noticeably better than a headset mic, and includes a genuinely useful mute button. Yes, it picks up background noise and lacks hardware controls, but for the money, it delivers where it matters. **D**

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